WATCHMEN ON THE WALL — TODAY'S WATCH

Monday, October 12, 2026

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1. UPDATE — Regional quartet backs Saudi countermeasures as Riyadh toll reaches 14 — WELL-CORROBORATED A new airport strike killed one more person, Turkey–Pakistan–Egypt–Saudi Arabia jointly endorsed legitimate defensive steps, and airstrikes reached Sanaa as the Yemen war widened.

2. Two tankers attacked near Hormuz; two Indian sailors missing — CONFIRMED A drone hit one tanker near Oman and an unknown projectile set another ablaze, adding two commercial ships and missing crew to the mounting pressure on Gulf navigation.

3. UPDATE — Claimed Ukraine–Russia energy ceasefire is followed by Russian strikes — WELL-CORROBORATED President Trump announced an immediate energy truce that Kyiv learned about through the media, but Russia then struck Ukrainian power and gas facilities while the EU imposed nearly 1,600 new sanctions listings.

1. UPDATE — Regional quartet backs Saudi countermeasures as Riyadh toll reaches 14

CONFIDENCE: WELL-CORROBORATED

Verified facts: Saudi authorities said another projectile struck King Khalid International Airport on Sunday, killing one person and injuring nearly a dozen. An Indian victim of Saturday's attack also died, raising the weekend airport toll to at least 14 with more than 320 injured. The airport remained closed Monday, while schools and major Riyadh businesses shifted online.

Turkey, Pakistan, Egypt and Saudi Arabia—the "R4"—jointly called the attacks an unjustifiable escalation, held the Houthis responsible and declared full support for legitimate Saudi measures to deter further strikes. Turkey and Pakistan already have collective-defense commitments with Saudi Arabia, although Ankara continues to rule out troop deployment and offensive operations. Reuters on the R4 statement and Associated Press regional update.

Houthi-run authorities reported that overnight airstrikes in Sanaa killed one person and wounded 12; they blamed Saudi Arabia, which had not confirmed responsibility. Iran separately offered to mediate between Riyadh and the Houthis.

What changed: The airport toll rose, the four-state grouping moved from separate expressions of support to a joint endorsement of Saudi countermeasures, and strikes reached residential and industrial sites in the Houthi-held capital while Iran presented itself as a mediator.

Prophetic relevance: The conflict is consolidating a multinational alignment around Saudi defense against an Iran-backed force and widening between national capitals. It remains a Yemen–Saudi theater rather than the Israel-directed invasion described in Ezekiel 38.

Scripture watch: Ezekiel 38:5–13; Daniel 11; Matthew 24:6–8.

2. Two tankers attacked near Hormuz; two Indian sailors missing

CONFIDENCE: CONFIRMED

Verified facts: India's Foreign Ministry said the MT Petro Dolphin, carrying 11 Indian seafarers, was struck by a drone near Sohar, Oman, on October 11. Nine crew members were rescued and two remained missing. The Marshall Islands-flagged MT Valthera, also carrying 11 Indian sailors, was struck by an unknown projectile in the Strait of Hormuz and caught fire; all aboard were reported safe.

India condemned the attacks and said its embassy in Muscat was coordinating rescue efforts with Omani authorities and the ship managers. No responsible party had been established. Associated Press and Indian Express citing India's ministries.

What changed: Recent briefings tracked a fall in Hormuz traffic after earlier tanker attacks; two named commercial vessels were now hit on the same day, with two sailors missing and a second ship set ablaze.

Prophetic relevance: Hormuz is not named in biblical prophecy, but violence against commercial shipping increases Iran-region pressure on trade, energy and scarcity. The attacks do not establish Ezekiel 38 or Revelation 6.

Scripture watch: Ezekiel 38:5–9; Matthew 24:6–7; Revelation 6:5–6.

3. UPDATE — Claimed Ukraine–Russia energy ceasefire is followed by Russian strikes

CONFIDENCE: WELL-CORROBORATED

Verified facts: President Trump announced Sunday that Russia and Ukraine had agreed to an immediate pause in attacks on energy infrastructure. President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said Ukraine learned of the claimed arrangement through media reports, would observe it if Russia did, and conducted no overnight refinery strikes.

Zelenskyy said Russia then struck a Kharkiv thermal power plant, a gas-production facility and a civilian gas station. Russia had not publicly confirmed the ceasefire. French President Emmanuel Macron said he had seen no evidence of Russian compliance, while EU ministers approved nearly 1,600 additional sanctions listings, more than half tied to ballistic-missile production chains. Reuters and Associated Press.

What changed: The U.S.–Russia diesel agreement and pressure on Ukraine have now produced a claimed wartime ceasefire, but Kyiv was not briefed on its terms and documented energy strikes immediately afterward while Europe expanded sanctions.

Prophetic relevance: A powerful intermediary attempting to impose a cross-border wartime arrangement merits attention to diplomacy and shifting alliances. This is not the Israel-centered covenant of Daniel 9:27 and does not identify Russia as Gog.

Scripture watch: Daniel 9:27; Ezekiel 38:1–9; Matthew 24:6–7.

JEWISH CALENDAR — NEXT 7 DAYS

Monday, October 12 — Rosh Chodesh Cheshvan: The second day of the new-month observance is 1 Cheshvan and concludes at nightfall. Rosh Chodesh worship is grounded in Numbers 10:10 and Numbers 28:11–15; Cheshvan contains no major biblical festival.

Friday evening–Saturday, October 16–17 — Shabbat Noach: Jerusalem candle lighting is 5:26 PM Friday, following the local 40-minutes-before-sunset custom. Standard Havdalah is 6:41 PM Saturday; a 42-minute convention gives 6:47 PM, while later customs vary. The reading is Genesis 6:9–11:32, covering the Flood, God's covenant with Noah and Babel.

Jewish days begin at sunset. Candle lighting precedes sunset, while Havdalah and observance endings follow halachic nightfall and vary by convention. Hebcal Jerusalem calendar.

SIGNS & ANNIVERSARY WATCH

October 16–17 — Lunar apogee: The Moon reaches the farthest portion of its monthly orbit around this period; published ephemerides differ slightly on the precise instant. This is a routine orbital event.

October 18 at approximately 16:12 UTC — 12:12 PM Eastern: The Moon reaches first quarter. No solar or lunar eclipse occurs during the next seven days, and the Orionid meteor shower peaks later, on October 21–22. Assessment: astronomically routine; no demonstrated prophetic significance. NASA GSFC Sky Events Calendar and Timeanddate lunar phases.

Modern State of Israel: Established May 14, 1948 — 78 years ago.

Jerusalem: Israel captured East Jerusalem and the Old City during the June 1967 Six-Day War — 59 years ago.

Neither reaches a new yearly anniversary this week. The establishment of the State of Israel and Israel's later capture of East Jerusalem are distinct historical events; Jerusalem is a city, not a nation.

ANTICHRIST WATCH — BIBLICAL TRAITS, NOT ACCUSATIONS

Donald Trump — new ceasefire-claim development, not identification.

Trump's announcement of an immediate Russia–Ukraine energy arrangement—before Kyiv knew its terms or Moscow publicly confirmed it—is relevant to monitoring unusually consequential personal diplomacy and influence over nations at war.

This is a watchlist of documented traits and developments, not identification of Trump or any living person as the Antichrist. The claimed energy truce is not a seven-year covenant involving Israel and supplies none of the sanctuary, worship, blasphemy or persecution markers in the cited passages.

Key passages: Daniel 7; Daniel 9:27; 2 Thessalonians 2; Revelation 13; 1 John 2.

What to Watch Next

1. Whether Saudi Arabia acknowledges the Sanaa strikes and whether the R4 statement produces new deployments, air-defense integration or retaliatory operations.
2. Whether the two missing Petro Dolphin sailors are found and whether investigators identify who attacked either tanker.
3. Whether Russia publicly accepts an energy ceasefire and halts strikes, or Ukraine resumes attacks on Russian refineries.
4. Whether Iran's mediation offer produces direct Saudi–Houthi talks while U.S. officials continue considering deeper military involvement.
5. Any material Temple Mount prayer, access, enforcement, Third Temple or red-heifer development.